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SECURITY



Minnesota activates National Guard as cyberattack on Saint Paul disrupts public services



Zack Whittaker — 8:50 AM PDT · July 30, 2025

Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz has activated the state's National Guard following a cyberattack on the state's capital, Saint Paul. City officials have not yet disclosed the [nature of the cyberattack](#), but the July 25 breach continues to disrupt city operations and some public services.

Saint Paul is one of the largest cities in the U.S., with more than 300,000 residents, and is the latest in a list of major cities targeted by [hackers](#) and [ransomware gangs](#) in [recent years](#).

In [a statement](#) on Tuesday, Walz said he authorized the National Guard's cyber forces at the city's request to help Saint Paul recover from the cyberattack, saying the "magnitude and complexity" of the breach exceeded the city's capacity to respond to the incident.

The National Guard will help to "ensure continuity of vital services and the safety and security of Saint Paul residents," Walz said.

Saint Paul Mayor Melvin Carter said in a press conference on Tuesday that the city took its government systems offline to contain the intruders, which sparked a citywide Wi-Fi outage.

Carter added that the city does not store much data on its residents, but said there was a risk that data on city employees had been stolen.

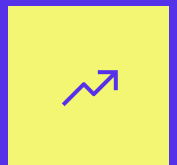
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UK data watchdog to fine NHS vendor Advanced for security failures prior to LockBit ransomware attack

Zack Whittaker — 4:01 PM PDT · August 6, 2024

U.K. data protection authorities have issued a provisional fine of more than £6 million to NHS vendor Advanced after finding that the company failed to properly secure the information of thousands of people later stolen in a ransomware attack.

IMAGE CREDITS:

RICHARD BAKER / IN PICTURES / GETTY IMAGES

In a statement, the U.K. Information Commissioner's office (ICO) said it issued the fine after determining that the cybercriminals behind the August 2022 ransomware attack "initially accessed a number of Advanced's health and care systems via a customer account that did not have multi-factor authentication."

The cyberattack on Advanced led to [widespread disruption to NHS services](#) across the United Kingdom at the time, causing outages at the NHS non-emergency 111 line and forcing hospitals and medical practices to resort to pen and paper for weeks. Physicians at affected NHS trusts reported that they [could not access patient records](#).

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Mandiant, the incident response firm that helped to investigate the hack, said malware used by the LockBit ransomware gang was used in the attack; though, LockBit never publicly claimed responsibility for the cyberattack on its dark web leak site. That can be an indication that a hacked company may have paid a ransom. Advanced [previously declined to say](#) if it had paid one.

By October 2022, Advanced said [in its post-incident report](#) that the cybercriminals broke into Advanced’s network “using legitimate third-party credentials,” implying that there was no multi-factor authentication on the account.

Now the ICO appears to be confirming that.

The ICO said it’s provisionally issuing a fine of £6.09 million (\$7.75 million) after the watchdog said Advanced provisionally “breached data protection law in failing to implement appropriate security measures prior to the attack to protect the personal information it was processing.”

The watchdog also confirmed that the cyberattack led to the theft of data of close to 83,000 people in the United Kingdom, including phone numbers and medical records, and details of “how to gain entry to the homes of 890 people who were receiving care at home,” the ICO said.

The fine is provisional, the watchdog said, meaning the penalty may change. ICO Commissioner John Edwards said the watchdog made the decision to go public in this case in part to “avoid similar incidents in the future.”

“I urge all organisations, especially those handling sensitive health data, to urgently secure external connections with multi-factor authentication,” said Edwards.

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Spokespeople for Advanced did not respond to a request for comment prior to publication.

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US sanctions LockBit members after ransomware takedown



The U.S. government has sanctioned two key members of LockBit, the Russian-speaking hacking and extortion gang accused of launching ransomware attacks against victims across the U.S. and internationally.

In a post on Tuesday, the U.S. Treasury confirmed it is sanctioning two Russian nationals, Artur Sungatov and Ivan Gennadievich Kondratiev.

Sungatov and Kondratiev were separately indicted by U.S. prosecutors on Tuesday for their alleged involvement with LockBit.

Kondratiev is also accused of involvement with REvil, RansomEXX and Avaddon ransomware gangs.

IMAGE CREDITS: KELVIN CHAN / AP

“The United States will not tolerate attempts to extort and steal from our citizens and institutions,” said U.S. Deputy Secretary of the Treasury Wally Adeyemo in a statement. “We will continue our whole-of-government approach to defend against malicious cyber activities, and will use all available tools to hold the actors that enable these threats accountable.”

The newly imposed sanctions mean it is now illegal for U.S. businesses or individuals to pay or otherwise transact with those named by sanctions, a tactic typically used to discourage American victims from paying a hacker’s ransom.

Sanctioning the individuals behind cyberattacks makes it more difficult for the individual hackers to

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[profit from ransomware](#), rather than targeting groups that can rebrand or change names to skirt sanctions.

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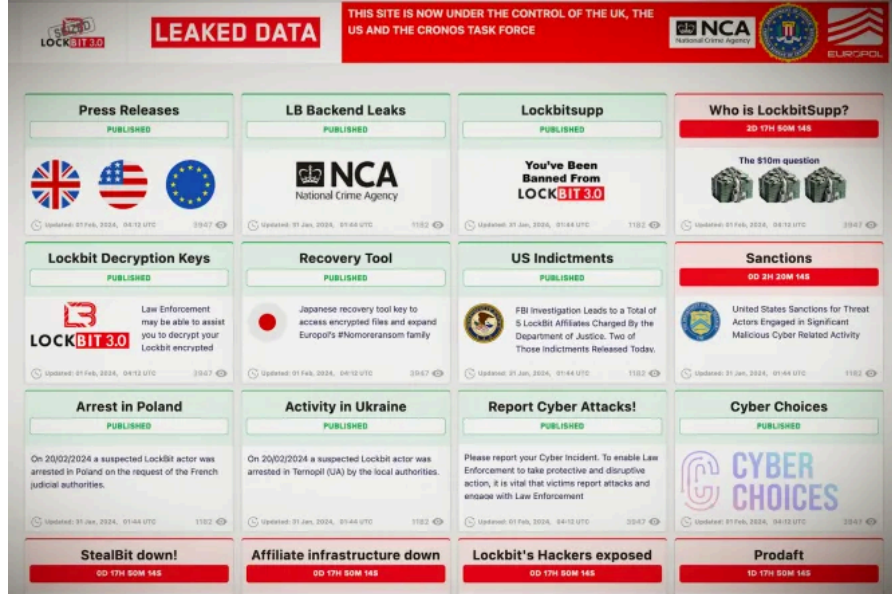
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authorities announced [a global law enforcement operation aimed at disrupting LockBit's infrastructure and operations](#). The authorities announced the seizure of LockBit's infrastructure on the gang's own dark web leak site, which the group [previously used to publish victims' stolen data](#) unless a ransom was paid.



A SCREENSHOT OF THE NOW-SEIZED LOCKBIT LEAK SITE.

IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH (SCREENSHOT)

U.S. prosecutors accuse LockBit’s operators of using ransomware in more than 2,000 cyberattacks against victims in the U.S. and worldwide, making some \$120 million in ransom payments since it was founded in 2019.

LockBit has taken credit for hundreds of hacks over the years, including [California’s Department of Finance](#), the [U.K. postal service Royal Mail](#) and [U.S. dental insurance giant MCNA](#), affecting millions of individuals’ personal information.

The U.S. sanctions announced Tuesday are the latest round of actions targeting the hackers behind LockBit and other prolific ransomware gangs.

In 2022, Russian-Canadian dual national [Mikhail Vasiliev was arrested](#) on allegations of launching multiple LockBit ransomware attacks. A year later, U.S. authorities [arrested Ruslan Magomedovich Astamirov](#) under similar allegations. Both suspects remain in custody awaiting trial.

A third suspect, Russian national Mikhail Pavlovich Matveev, was accused of involvement in several ransomware operations, including LockBit. Matveev, who remains at large, was [subject to U.S.](#)

[sanctions in 2023](#), preventing U.S. victims from paying a ransom to him or his associated ransomware gangs, [including Hive and Babuk](#). The U.S. government also has a \$10 million reward for information leading to Matveev's arrest.

In its announcement Tuesday, the U.S. government did not yet name the suspected LockBit ringleader, who goes by the moniker LockBitSupp. The now-seized LockBit dark web leak site says law enforcement plans to release more information on the alleged leader on Friday, including details of a \$10 million bounty for information leading to their location or identification.

Besides sanctions, the U.S. does not ban or otherwise restrict victims from paying a ransom, though the FBI has long advised victims against paying off hackers for fear of perpetuating future cyberattacks. Security researchers say that ransomware victims who pay a ransom are [more likely to experience subsequent ransomware attacks](#).

Read more on TechCrunch:

[Why are ransomware gangs making so much money?](#)

[Why ransomware victims can't stop paying off hackers](#)

[Do government sanctions against ransomware groups work?](#)

[Why extortion is the new ransomware threat](#)

Authorities disrupt operations of notorious LockBit ransomware gang



A coalition of international law enforcement agencies, including the U.S. Federal Bureau of Investigation and the U.K.'s National Crime Agency, have disrupted the operations of the notorious LockBit ransomware gang. LockBit's dark web leak site — where the group publicly lists its victims and threatens to leak their stolen data unless a ransom demand is ...

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Fidelity National Financial says hackers stole data on 1.3 million customers

Zack Whittaker — 2:05 PM PST · January 9, 2024

Real estate services giant Fidelity National Financial has confirmed hackers stole data on 1.3 million of its customers during a November cyberattack that knocked the company offline for a week.

FNF said [in a filing Tuesday with federal regulators](#):

IMAGE CREDITS: LORIE WOLFE/REUTERS VIA GETTY IMAGES
“We determined that an unauthorized third-party accessed certain FNF systems, deployed a type of malware that is not self-propagating, and exfiltrated certain data.” The company said it has “notified its affected customers and applicable state attorneys general and regulators, and approximately 1.3 million potentially impacted consumers.”

The filing did not say what specific customer data was stolen, but said FNF is providing credit monitoring and identity theft services to affected customers, suggesting that the stolen customer information was personal or sensitive in nature.

FNF spokesperson Lisa Foxworthy-Parker did not respond to TechCrunch’s email requesting further details.

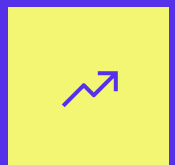
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FNF said [it “contained” the cyberattack on November 26](#) following a week-long outage that virtually froze all of the company and much of its subsidiaries’ operations. Customers were unable to pay their mortgages. One of FNF’s subsidiaries [described the incident as a “catastrophe” in an automated message](#) for customers.

The ransomware gang known as ALPHV (or BlackCat) claimed responsibility for the FNF cyberattack in a post on its dark web leak site, which it uses to extort victims into paying the hackers to remove and delete the data. ALPHV subsequently removed FNF from its site.

Ransomware and [extortion gangs sometimes remove a victim’s information](#) when they pay the ransom.

FNF was one of several corporate victims of cyberattacks in recent weeks targeting the mortgage and loan industry, including [LoanDepot](#) and [Mr. Cooper](#).

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Fidelity National Financial shuts down network in wake of cybersecurity incident



Fidelity National Financial, or FNF, a Fortune 500 company that provides title insurance and settlement services for the mortgage and real estate industries, announced on Tuesday that it was the victim of a “cybersecurity incident that impacted certain FNF systems.” The company filed a report with the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) saying that it ... Continue reading

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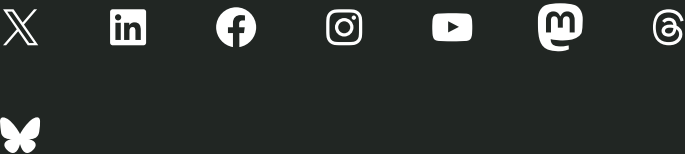


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